



APR 01 2016

P.O. Box 3044 Salt Lake City, UT 84130-0449

March 11, 2016



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Attn: Practice Administrator

Robyn B. Vera, DO

1200 Basich Blvd

Aberdeen WA 98520-1035

Re: New Reimbursement Guideline for Simulation before the IMRT Treatment Plan to Align with CMS Policy – Effective April 1

Dear Practice Administrator:

To align with the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services' (CMS) annual update to its National Correct Coding Initiative Coding (NCCI) Policy Manual for Medicare Services, UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage plans will not reimburse for simulation services rendered for CPT® codes 77280, 77285 and 77290 before the Intensity Modulated Radiation Therapy (IMRT) treatment plan. The change is effective April 4, 2016.

UnitedHealthcare uses CMS's NCCI Policy Manual as the basis for our UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Delivery of IMRT/SRS/SBRT Reimbursement Policy and make changes accordingly.

Claims for simulation with a date of service before or the same date as the treatment plan for IMRT with the listed CPT codes will be denied as "Unbundled Service". Paid claims for simulation will also be reviewed post-payment. If determined that simulation codes were billed for services before, or the same date as the IMRT treatment plan, monies will be recouped starting April 1, 2016.

The UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Delivery of IMRT/SRS/SBRT Reimbursement Policy has been updated to be consistent with the NCCI Policy Manual for simulation before the IMRT treatment plan. The NCCI Policy Manual was updated in January 2014 to indicate that the same date of service procedure-to-procedure edits between CPT code 77301 and pre-IMRT plan simulation codes would be extended to include all simulation activities associated with the development of the IMRT plan whether these procedures are reported on the same or different dates of service.

The American Medical Association's Relative Value Scale Update Committee (RUC) has indicated that the work process involved in creating an IMRT treatment plan includes all simulation services performed in the development of the IMRT plan, and the practice expense relative value units (PE RVUs) associated with CPT code 77290 were included in the valuation of CPT code 77301.

The updated UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Delivery of IMRT/SRS/SBRT Reimbursement Policy will be posted under UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Reimbursement Policies on UnitedHealthcareOnline.com as of April 1, 2016. To view the NCCI Policy Manual, visit cms.gov.

If you have questions, please email us at unitedoncology@uhc.com. Thank you.

Sincerely,

Lee N. Newcomer, MD
Senior Vice President